

Group Discussion

Placement Training Program

GD Structure & Etiquette

A group discussion is evaluated on both content and behavior — evaluators are watching how candidates interact, not only what they say. Basic etiquette matters more than most candidates expect: not interrupting others mid-sentence, actively listening rather than only waiting for a turn to speak, and acknowledging a previous speaker's point before adding your own ('Building on what X said...') demonstrates collaborative thinking, which is often exactly what a GD round is designed to assess.

Forming Arguments

A strong contribution in a GD states a clear point, backs it with a specific reason or example (not just an assertion), and stays relevant to the actual topic rather than drifting into a tangentially related point. Quality of contribution consistently matters more than quantity — one well-reasoned, on-topic point that moves the discussion forward is worth more to an evaluator than several vague or repetitive comments made just to be seen speaking.

Handling Disagreement

Disagreeing productively in a GD means challenging a point, not the person who made it — phrases like 'I see it differently because...' keep the disagreement about ideas rather than becoming personal or confrontational. Staying calm and articulate when directly challenged by another participant, rather than becoming defensive or raising your voice, is itself one of the specific behaviors evaluators are watching for, since it signals how a candidate might handle disagreement in a real workplace.

Time Management in GDs

A group discussion typically runs 10-15 minutes among several participants, so airtime is genuinely scarce and needs deliberate management. Practical tactics: speaking early (within the first few exchanges) to establish presence rather than waiting for a 'perfect' moment that may never come, keeping individual contributions reasonably concise rather than monopolizing time, and being ready to actively bring in a quieter participant's view if a natural opening arises — the latter specifically signals group-oriented, collaborative behavior that many evaluators explicitly look for.

Learn More

Indeed Career Guide — Group Discussion Tips

<https://www.indeed.com/career-advice>

PrepInsta — Group Discussion Topics & Tips

<https://prepinsta.com/>

Harvard Business Review — Communication

<https://hbr.org/topic/subject/communication>